Human Energy Economics (HEE)

A Theory of Organizational Capacity and Sustainable Execution

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HEE AT A GLANCE

Core Idea

> **Organizations do not sustain performance merely by possessing resources, people, or capability. They sustain it by preserving, developing, connecting, enabling, mobilizing, and applying those assets — repeatedly, without unnecessarily degrading the capacity required to do it again.**

The HEE Question

> **What limits an organization's ability to apply available capacity and capability sustainably?**

Signature Principle

> **Extraction depletes. Cultivation compounds.**

Six Execution Factors

Execution Factor	HEE Meaning
Demand	The load and activity placed on organizational capacity
Human Energy	The cognitive, emotional, and physical capacity people bring to and require for work
Capability	The potential to perform, solve, decide, or create
Connection	Whether distributed capability can work together and reach the point of need

Execution Factor	HEE Meaning
Decision Quality	Whether scarce capacity is being directed effectively
Enablement	Whether organizational conditions permit capability to be applied

Five Diagnostic Conditions

Condition	What it means	Primary response
Depletion	Capacity is unnecessarily consumed or degraded	**Recover**
Deficiency	Required capability is missing	**Develop**
Disconnection	Capability exists but is not effectively connected	**Connect**
Constraint	Organizational conditions prevent application	**Enable**
Conversion Failure	Relevant potential exists, but valuable application still fails	**Investigate**

Quick Diagnostic

1. What is the objective?
2. What demand is being placed on capacity?
3. What Human Energy is required and being consumed?
4. What capability exists?
5. Is the relevant capability connected to the point of need?
6. Are organizational conditions enabling application?
7. Is Decision Quality directing scarce capacity appropriately?
8. What is the limiting condition?
9. What response is required?
10. What happened to capacity as a result?

Strategic Test

> **Can the organization consistently deliver what it needs to deliver — without consuming the capacity required to do it again?**

HEE Logic

CAPACITY → APPLICATION → EXECUTION → VALUE CREATION → LEARNING → ADAPTATION → RENEWED CAPACITY

In Compact Form

One economic lens.
Two economic assets: Human Energy · Organizational Capacity
Six execution factors.
Five diagnostic conditions.
One central question: *What limits application?*

"HEE at a Glance" is an orientation summary of the canonical framework. The numbered sections that follow constitute the full canonical treatment.

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1. THE HEE IDENTITY

Human Energy Economics (HEE) is a management theory concerned with the economics of organizational capacity and sustainable execution.

HEE examines how organizations preserve, develop, connect, enable, mobilize, and apply their available potential across successive execution cycles.

Dimension	HEE Identity
Management Theory	Human Energy Economics
Economic Assets	Organizational Capacity · Human Energy
Execution Factors	Demand · Human Energy · Capability · Connection · Decision Quality · Enablement
Diagnostic Conditions	Depletion · Deficiency · Disconnection · Constraint · Conversion Failure
Diagnostic Responses	Recover · Develop · Connect · Enable · Investigate
Strategic Context Lens	3C — Source · Dependency · Constraint
Governing Question	What prevents the organization from turning its capacity and Human Energy into sustainable results?
Central Diagnostic Question	What limits application?
Value Objective	Increase valuable application and sustained execution without unnecessarily degrading future capacity

Dimension	HEE Identity
Cross-Cutting Principle	Protect
Signature Principle	Extraction depletes. Cultivation compounds.

HEE does not treat performance as a function of output alone. It asks what producing that output consumes, what it creates, what it depletes, what it develops, and what capacity remains for subsequent execution.

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2. HEE IN ONE SENTENCE

> **Human Energy Economics (HEE) is a management theory of organizational capacity and sustainable execution that examines how organizations preserve, develop, connect, enable, mobilize, and apply capacity across successive execution cycles.**

HEE therefore shifts attention from performance as an isolated output to performance as a repeated organizational process.

The central concern is not simply:

> **Did the organization achieve the result?**

It is also:

> **What did achieving the result require, consume, create, preserve, or degrade — and what capacity remains for the next cycle?**

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3. FOUNDATIONAL DISTINCTIONS

HEE depends on several distinctions that prevent important organizational constructs from being collapsed into one another.

Human Capital ≠ Human Energy ≠ Organizational Capacity

Human Capital refers broadly to the knowledge, skills, experience, competencies, and other attributes embodied in people that can contribute to economic or organizational value.

Human Energy refers to the cognitive, emotional, and physical capacity people bring to work and require to apply capability and participate effectively in execution.

Organizational Capacity is an organization-level asset representing its underlying potential and means to mobilize and sustain action.

Human Capital can contribute to capability. Human Energy affects the ability to mobilize and apply that capability. Organizational Capacity encompasses a broader organizational system of potential and means.

They are related, but they are not interchangeable.

Capability = Potential

Capability represents what an individual, team, function, or organization is capable of doing.

> **Capability = Potential.**

Capability alone does not guarantee application.

Capacity = Ability to Apply

Capacity, in the execution context, concerns the ability to mobilize and apply available potential under actual conditions.

> **Capacity = Ability to Apply.**

Knowledge alone is potential.

> **Applied knowledge is power.**

Effective Application

Effective Application is the purposeful realization of available potential in a particular context.

A capability can exist without being effectively applied.

Execution

Execution is the conversion of intended action into actual action and outcomes.

Application precedes or enables execution, but application and execution are not identical.

Sustained Execution

Sustained Execution concerns continued ability to produce intended results across successive cycles without unnecessarily degrading the capacity required for future execution.

Consumption ≠ Drain

Consumption is not inherently harmful.

Work necessarily consumes resources and Human Energy.

Drain occurs when capacity is consumed, depleted, impaired, diverted, or lost without sufficient productive contribution, necessary protection, capability development, or legitimate expected future value.

Deficiency ≠ Disconnection ≠ Constraint

Deficiency: the required capability is absent.

Disconnection: relevant capability exists but is not effectively connected to the point of need.

Constraint: relevant capability exists but organizational conditions prevent effective application.

These conditions require different responses.

Application ≠ Execution

Application concerns whether potential is being purposefully realized.

Execution concerns whether intended action and outcomes are actually produced.

Execution ≠ Sustained Execution

An organization can execute successfully in one cycle while degrading the capacity required for future cycles.

HEE therefore treats sustainability of execution as an economic concern rather than merely an environmental or temporal one.

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4. THE HEE ECONOMIC QUESTION

Traditional performance questions often emphasize:

- What did we produce?
- How quickly did we produce it?
- How much did it cost?
- Did we meet the target?

HEE adds a capacity question:

What did producing the result do to the organization's capacity to produce the next result?

This creates a broader economic perspective.

HEE asks organizations to examine:

- what capacity they possess;
- what capacity is usable;
- where capacity is consumed;
- where Human Energy is unnecessarily consumed;
- where capability is missing;
- where capability is disconnected;
- where organizational conditions constrain application;
- how decisions allocate scarce capacity;
- what execution creates;
- what execution depletes;
- and whether capacity is renewed.

The objective is not to eliminate consumption.

The objective is to improve the relationship between **capacity consumed, value created, and capacity preserved or renewed.**

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5. RELATED WORK AND THEORETICAL POSITION

HEE does not claim that the underlying ideas of resources, demands, performance opportunity, capability, or resource preservation were previously undiscovered.

It builds on established bodies of research while proposing a distinct management-theory integration.

5.1 Conservation of Resources

Hobfoll's Conservation of Resources (COR) theory emphasizes the acquisition, preservation, and loss of valued resources.

HEE is compatible with the resource-preservation logic of COR but extends the organizational question toward the economics of capacity consumption, application, execution, and renewal.

5.2 Job Demands–Resources Perspective

The Job Demands–Resources (JD-R) model distinguishes demands from resources and examines their relationship with strain and motivation.

HEE draws on the insight that demands and resources affect sustainable functioning while placing the question within a broader organizational-capacity and execution architecture.

5.3 Ability–Motivation–Opportunity / Opportunity-to-Perform Perspective

Blumberg and Pringle's work on organizational performance emphasizes ability, willingness, and opportunity to perform.

HEE particularly connects with the opportunity-to-perform logic: capability alone does not guarantee performance when organizational conditions prevent its application.

5.4 HEE's Theoretical Position

HEE is positioned as:

> **A management theory that integrates resource-preservation, work-demand, performance-opportunity, capability, organizational-condition, and execution perspectives around the organizational conversion problem between potential, application, sustained execution, and future capacity.**

HEE's distinctive emphasis is therefore not any one individual construct, but the relationship among:

Potential → Application → Execution → Future Capacity

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6. THE HEE PROBLEM

Organizations can possess:

- capable people;
- knowledge;
- technology;
- resources;
- processes;
- systems;
- experience;
- strategic direction;

and still struggle to execute consistently.

HEE proposes that this can occur because organizational potential does not automatically become usable capacity or effective application.

Growth often increases:

- functions;
- specialization;
- systems;
- decisions;
- dependencies;
- handoffs;
- coordination;
- reporting;
- exceptions;
- competing priorities.

As interconnectedness increases, fragmentation can increase as well.

The resulting condition may create:

ORGANIZATIONAL FRAGMENTATION → OPERATIONAL NOISE + DISCONNECTED CAPABILITY → HUMAN ENERGY LEAKAGE + ENABLEMENT CONSTRAINTS → ORGANIZATIONAL DRAIN → EXECUTION DEGRADATION → CUSTOMER FRICTION → VALUE LOSS

This is a conceptual diagnostic pathway, not a universal causal law.

The HEE problem is therefore not simply lack of capability.

It is also the failure to convert available potential into valuable application and sustained execution.

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7. A POSSIBLE HEE PATHWAY

HEE proposes the following conceptual pathway:

ORGANIZATIONAL FRAGMENTATION

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OPERATIONAL NOISE + DISCONNECTED CAPABILITY

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HUMAN ENERGY LEAKAGE + ENABLEMENT CONSTRAINTS

↓

ORGANIZATIONAL DRAIN

↓

EXECUTION DEGRADATION

↓

CUSTOMER FRICTION

↓

VALUE LOSS

The pathway is intended as a diagnostic narrative.

It should not be interpreted as claiming that every organization follows the same sequence or that every instance of one condition necessarily produces the next.

HEE uses the pathway to ask where the conversion from organizational potential to valuable execution is being disrupted.

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8. THE HEE DIAGNOSTIC MODEL

HEE organizes common execution problems into five diagnostic conditions.

Diagnostic condition	Core question	Primary response
Depletion	Is usable capacity being unnecessarily consumed or degraded?	**Recover**
Deficiency	Is required capability missing?	**Develop**
Disconnection	Does relevant capability exist but fail to connect to the point of need?	**Connect**
Constraint	Do organizational conditions prevent application?	**Enable**
Conversion Failure	Does relevant potential appear sufficient, yet valuable application or execution still fail?	**Investigate**

These categories are diagnostic distinctions rather than claims that all organizational problems can be reduced to one category.

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9. THE FIVE DIAGNOSTIC QUESTIONS

HEE uses five primary diagnostic questions:

1. What is being consumed?

Identifies demand, Human Energy use, capacity use, operational activity, coordination, and other consumption.

2. What is missing?

Identifies capability deficiency.

3. What exists but is not connected?

Identifies capability that exists but is not reaching the point of need.

4. What prevents application?

Identifies organizational enablement constraints.

5. Why does execution still fail when the apparent ingredients are present?

Identifies possible conversion failure and triggers investigation.

These questions are intended to prevent premature intervention.

The organization should first understand the limiting condition before choosing the response.

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10. ORGANIZATIONAL DRAIN

HEE defines Organizational Drain as:

> **An economic condition in which organizational capacity is consumed, depleted, impaired, diverted, or lost without sufficient productive contribution, necessary protection, capability development, or legitimate expected future value.**

Drain may occur through:

- unnecessary demand;
- excessive coordination;
- avoidable rework;
- decision friction;
- duplicated activity;

- capability underutilization;
- attention fragmentation;
- preventable interruptions;
- poorly designed processes;
- excessive complexity;
- recurring exceptions;
- misallocated capacity;
- avoidable Human Energy consumption.

Organizational Drain is broader than any one operational symptom.

It is an economic condition concerning the relationship between capacity consumption and value.

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11. HUMAN ENERGY IN HEE

Human Energy is a central economic asset in HEE.

It refers to the:

- cognitive;
- emotional;
- and physical

capacity people bring to work and require to apply capability and participate effectively in execution.

Human Energy is not synonymous with:

- engagement;
- motivation;
- morale;
- well-being;
- productivity;
- satisfaction;
- or burnout.

Those constructs may interact with Human Energy but should not be collapsed into it.

Human Energy is also not equivalent to whole Organizational Capacity.

People are part of organizational systems, but Organizational Capacity includes much more than the energy available from individuals.

HEE treats Human Energy as an asset that can be:

- consumed;

- protected;
- depleted;
- recovered;
- developed;
- redirected;
- and unnecessarily leaked.

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12. HUMAN ENERGY ECONOMIC LOGIC

HEE does not assume that all Human Energy consumption is harmful.

Human Energy consumption can be categorized conceptually as:

Productive Consumption

Energy directly applied to valuable work and desired outcomes.

Necessary Consumption

Energy required for legitimate organizational functioning even where direct value is not immediately visible.

Developmental Consumption

Energy invested in learning, capability development, experimentation, and improvement.

Protective Consumption

Energy invested in preventing greater future loss, risk, failure, or depletion.

Unproductive Consumption

Energy consumed through activity that produces insufficient value relative to the capacity required.

The objective is therefore not:

> **Minimize Human Energy consumption.**

It is:

> **Increase value generated per unit of usable Human Energy while protecting future execution capacity.**

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13. BURNOUT AS A SIGNAL

HEE recognizes burnout as potentially important evidence of unsustainable conditions but does not make burnout the foundation of the theory.

Burnout is not treated as:

- proof of organizational failure;
- proof of individual weakness;
- a single-cause phenomenon;
- or a complete measure of Human Energy.

Burnout may be a signal that warrants investigation into:

- demands;
- resources;
- recovery;
- organizational conditions;
- work design;
- decision friction;
- capacity allocation;
- and other relevant conditions.

HEE therefore treats burnout as a possible signal within a broader system rather than as the central explanatory construct.

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14. CAPACITY AND CAPABILITY

Organizational Capacity

Organizational Capacity is an organization-level economic asset representing underlying potential and means to mobilize and sustain action.

It can include:

- resources;
- systems;
- processes;
- technology;
- structures;
- relationships;
- decision capacity;
- routines;
- people;

- capabilities;
- and organizational arrangements.

Usable Capacity

Usable Capacity is the portion of organizational potential that can actually be mobilized under current conditions.

Capacity in the Execution Context

In HEE, capacity concerns the organization’s ability to mobilize and apply available potential under actual conditions.

Capability

Capability is potential.

> **Capability = Potential.**

Effective Application

Effective Application is purposeful realization of potential.

Execution

Execution is the production of intended action and outcomes.

Sustained Execution

Sustained Execution is the continued production of intended results without unnecessarily degrading future execution capacity.

Thus:

Capability → Application → Execution → Sustained Execution

The transition is not automatic.

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15. THE HEE TRANSFORMATION

HEE reframes the management problem from:

How do we get more output?

toward:

How do we increase valuable application and execution while preserving the capacity required for future execution?

The transformation is:

Potential

↓

Usable Capacity

↓

Effective Application

↓

Execution

↓

Sustained Execution

↓

Renewed Capacity

The critical management problem is the conversion between these states.

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16. THE SIX EXECUTION FACTORS

HEE identifies six factors that shape execution:

1. **Demand**
2. **Human Energy**
3. **Capability**
4. **Connection**
5. **Decision Quality**
6. **Enablement**

These factors are not homogeneous variables.

They represent different types of conditions affecting an organization's ability to convert potential into application and execution.

Demand

What is being placed on capacity?

Human Energy

What human capacity is available, required, and being consumed?

Capability

What potential exists?

Connection

Can distributed capability connect to the point of need?

Decision Quality

Is scarce capacity being directed through sufficiently sound decisions?

Enablement

Do organizational conditions permit capability to be applied?

The factors should be diagnosed together rather than assumed to have identical effects.

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17. DEMAND

Demand is the work, activity, request, decision, interruption, coordination, reporting, exception, or other load placed on organizational capacity.

Demand may be:

- valuable;
- necessary;
- avoidable;
- low-value;
- recurring;
- unpredictable;
- or structurally generated.

HEE does not assume that all demand should be reduced.

The relevant question is:

> **Which demand creates sufficient value relative to the capacity it consumes?**

Unnecessary recurring operational demand is a particular focus of the Operational Silence Framework (OSF).

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18. DECISION QUALITY

Decision Quality concerns whether scarce organizational capacity is being directed through sufficiently sound decisions.

Poor decisions can:

- misallocate capacity;
- create unnecessary work;
- generate rework;
- increase coordination;
- amplify operational noise;
- consume Human Energy;
- delay execution;
- and degrade future capacity.

HEE identifies Decision Quality as an execution factor because the allocation of scarce capacity is itself an economic concern.

Decision Quality is **not** a separate HEMS mechanism.

HEE identifies and diagnoses when Decision Quality limits capacity allocation and execution.

Improvement may appropriately draw on established disciplines including:

- decision science;
- governance;
- strategic prioritization;
- risk management;
- management control;
- and other relevant decision practices.

HEE does not claim exclusive ownership of Decision Quality.

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19. CAPABILITY INTERCONNECTION

Organizations frequently possess capability that is distributed across:

- functions;
- teams;
- specialists;
- systems;
- locations;
- business units;
- partners;
- and organizational boundaries.

The existence of capability does not guarantee that it can be effectively accessed or combined.

The relevant questions include:

- What capability exists?
- Where does it exist?
- Who needs it?
- When is it needed?
- What prevents connection?
- What interfaces create friction?
- What dependencies must be coordinated?

Settled HEE Mapping

> **The Connection execution factor is operationalized through the Capability Interconnection mechanism.**

Capability Interconnection therefore addresses the conversion of distributed capability into connected organizational potential.

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20. CAPABILITY CONNECTION GAP

A Capability Connection Gap exists when relevant capability is available somewhere in the organization but is not effectively connected to the point of need.

This may occur because of:

- organizational silos;
- poor information flow;
- unclear ownership;
- geographic separation;

• incompatible systems;
• weak interfaces;
• fragmented processes;
• missing relationships;
• coordination barriers;
• or dependency complexity.

The problem is not necessarily capability deficiency.

The capability may already exist.

The required response is therefore often:

> **Connect.**

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21. ORGANIZATIONAL ENABLEMENT

Organizational Enablement concerns the conditions that allow available capability to be applied.

Capability can exist without application when conditions are inadequate.

Examples include:

• insufficient resources;
• structural barriers;
• cultural resistance;
• unclear authority;
• decision constraints;
• inadequate support;
• environmental barriers;
• or poorly configured systems.

HEE therefore asks:

> **What organizational condition is preventing available capability from being applied?**

This creates a clear distinction between developing capability and enabling existing capability.

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22. THE ENABLEMENT GAP

An Enablement Gap exists when relevant capability exists but organizational conditions constrain its application.

This is distinct from capability deficiency.

If the capability is absent:

> **Develop.**

If the capability exists but cannot be applied:

> **Enable.**

The concept is compatible with the opportunity-to-perform perspective in organizational performance research.

HEE therefore treats enablement as an organizational condition rather than an individual capability problem.

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23. THE HEE GAP MODEL

HEE organizes five important diagnostic gaps:

Gap / Condition	Meaning	Response
Human Energy Gap	Required usable Human Energy is depleted or unnecessarily consumed	**Recover**
Capability Gap	Required capability is absent	**Develop**
Capability Connection Gap	Relevant capability exists but is not connected	**Connect**
Enablement Gap	Relevant capability exists but conditions prevent application	**Enable**
Execution Deficit	Intended execution is not achieved	**Investigate**

Execution Deficit is an outcome condition.

It should not automatically be treated as the root cause.

An execution deficit may result from one or several preceding conditions.

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24. HUMAN ENERGY LEAKAGE

Human Energy Leakage describes unnecessary loss or diversion of usable Human Energy.

HEE identifies three conceptual forms:

Demand Leakage

Human Energy consumed by unnecessary, avoidable, or low-value demand.

Attention Leakage

Human Energy diverted through interruption, fragmentation, context switching, excessive coordination, or competing demands.

Capability Leakage

Human Energy consumed because available capability is poorly utilized, disconnected, or repeatedly recreated.

Human Energy Leakage is a human-capacity manifestation within the broader condition of Organizational Drain.

It is not synonymous with Organizational Drain.

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25. OPERATIONAL NOISE

Operational Noise is the operational manifestation of unnecessary recurring friction and activity.

It may include:

- duplicated reporting;
- unnecessary meetings;
- repeated approvals;
- avoidable escalation;
- rework;
- excessive coordination;
- process complexity;
- unnecessary handoffs;
- recurring exceptions;
- fragmented information;
- redundant activity;
- and other recurring operational burdens.

Operational Noise is not synonymous with Organizational Drain.

It is a mechanism or manifestation through which organizational capacity may be consumed.

The relevant economic question is:

What capacity does this operational noise consume, and what value does it create?

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26. THE HEE MANAGEMENT LOGIC

HEE organizes its broad intervention logic as:

PROTECT → DIAGNOSE → RECOVER / DEVELOP / CONNECT / ENABLE / INVESTIGATE → APPLY → EXECUTE → LEARN → ADAPT → RENEW

Protect

Prevent unnecessary degradation where possible.

Diagnose

Identify the actual limiting condition.

Recover

Restore depleted or unnecessarily consumed capacity.

Develop

Build missing capability.

Connect

Link distributed capability to the point of need.

Enable

Change organizational conditions that prevent application.

Investigate

Examine conversion failure or unresolved execution deficits.

Apply

Turn potential into effective application.

Execute

Convert application into intended action and outcomes.

Learn

Capture information from execution.

Adapt

Change based on learning and changing conditions.

Renew

Protect, restore, develop, and reinvest in future capacity.

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27. PROTECTION AS A CROSS-CUTTING PRINCIPLE

Protection is not a separate diagnostic response.

It is a cross-cutting principle.

Organizations should protect:

- usable Human Energy;
- capability;
- attention;
- decision capacity;
- relationships;
- critical systems;
- operational capacity;
- and future execution capability.

Protection does not mean avoiding all consumption.

It means avoiding unnecessary degradation of assets required for valuable future execution.

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28. THE HUMAN ENERGY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

The **Human Energy Management System (HEMS)** is the operating-system layer through which HEE can be translated into organizational management practice.

HEMS coordinates complementary mechanisms and frameworks including:

- Human Energy Audit (HEA);
- Human Energy Recovery Framework (HERF);
- Human Energy Development Plan (HEDP);

• Capability Interconnection;
• Human Energy Enablement (HEEn);
• 3C Strategic Context Lens;
• Execution Excellence System (EES);
• and the supporting OSF + 5R demand-reduction pathway.

These elements are complementary.

HEMS does not require every element to operate in a fixed sequence.

Decision Quality in HEMS

Decision Quality is a HEE execution factor rather than a separate HEMS mechanism.

HEE identifies and diagnoses its effect on capacity allocation and execution, while improvement may appropriately draw on established decision and governance disciplines.

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29. HUMAN ENERGY AUDIT

The **Human Energy Audit (HEA)** provides visibility into the conditions affecting Human Energy and usable organizational capacity.

Potential audit areas include:

• demand;
• Human Energy;
• attention;
• interruptions;
• coordination;
• decision friction;
• rework;
• capability utilization;
• energy-draining processes;
• capacity risks;
• recurring operational burdens.

The objective is not simply to measure how busy people are.

It is to understand:

> **What is consuming usable capacity, why, and with what consequence?**

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30. HUMAN ENERGY RECOVERY FRAMEWORK

The **Human Energy Recovery Framework (HERF)** focuses on recovering depleted or unnecessarily consumed capacity.

Recovery can involve:

- removing unnecessary demand;
- reducing avoidable friction;
- redesigning work;
- improving recovery conditions;
- protecting attention;
- changing harmful patterns;
- restoring usable capacity.

HERF does not mean reducing all work.

Its purpose is to recover capacity that can be made available for valuable application and future execution.

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31. HUMAN ENERGY DEVELOPMENT PLAN

The **Human Energy Development Plan (HEDP)** addresses capability development where required capability is missing or insufficient.

Development may include:

- knowledge;
- skills;
- experience;
- practice;
- coaching;
- learning;
- capability building;
- and organizational learning.

The distinction remains:

> **If capability is missing, develop it.**

If capability already exists but cannot be applied, the problem belongs primarily to connection or enablement rather than development.

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32. HUMAN ENERGY ENABLEMENT

Human Energy Enablement (HEEn) is the specialized framework within HEMS that examines the organizational conditions between capability and application.

Its foundational distinction is:

> **Capability is not the same as application.**

HEEn addresses situations in which relevant capability exists but is not being effectively applied because organizational conditions constrain its use.

HEEn is therefore:

- not capability development when capability already exists;
- not Human Energy recovery;
- not demand reduction.

HEEn works in combination with:

- 3C;
- Capability Interconnection;
- OSF + 5R;
- EES;
- and the wider HEE diagnostic architecture.

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33. THE SIX ENABLEMENT DIMENSIONS

HEEn identifies six broad enablement dimensions:

1. **Resource Enablement**
2. **Structural Enablement**
3. **Cultural Enablement**
4. **Decision Enablement**
5. **Support Enablement**
6. **Environmental Enablement**

These dimensions identify different organizational conditions that may influence application.

Resource Enablement

Whether the resources required to apply capability are available.

Structural Enablement

Whether organizational structures, roles, authority, and interfaces permit action.

Cultural Enablement

Whether norms, expectations, and behavioral patterns support application.

Decision Enablement

Whether people have access to the decision conditions, authority, information, and processes needed to act.

Support Enablement

Whether assistance, systems, leadership, expertise, and operational support are available.

Environmental Enablement

Whether the physical, technological, temporal, or contextual environment permits effective application.

HEE recognizes these dimensions, while detailed diagnostic tests, measures, interventions, and implementation guidance belong to HEEn.

Decision Enablement ≠ Decision Quality

Decision Enablement concerns the organizational conditions supporting decision-making.

Decision Quality concerns whether the decision itself is sufficiently sound for the context.

The two should not be conflated.

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34. 3C — THE STRATEGIC CONTEXT LENS

The **3C Strategic Context Lens** examines:

Source · Dependency · Constraint

Source

Where does the condition, demand, friction, or problem originate?

Dependency

What depends on the activity, decision, capability, or resource?

Constraint

What limits the ability to act, change, or execute?

3C is a strategic diagnostic and contextual lens.

It is not:

- a diagnostic response;
- an intervention mechanism;
- a replacement for HEE diagnosis;
- or a component absorbed into Capability Interconnection.

3C helps determine **where to look and how to understand context** before choosing an intervention.

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35. OSF AND THE 5R CASCADE

The **Operational Silence Framework (OSF)** addresses unnecessary recurring operational demand and Operational Noise.

Its central proposition is:

> **Stop Managing Chaos. Start Engineering Silence.**

OSF uses the **5R Cascade**:

REMOVE → REDUCE → REPLACE → RE-ENGINEER → RETAIN

Remove

Eliminate activity that creates insufficient value.

Reduce

Decrease necessary activity to an appropriate level.

Replace

Substitute a lower-cost or lower-friction approach.

Re-engineer

Redesign the underlying process or operating condition.

Retain

Protect what remains valuable and prevent unnecessary reintroduction of removed demand.

OSF principles include:

- **Question before optimizing.**
- **Remove before reducing.**
- **Simplify before automating.**
- **Protect released capacity.**
- **Measure what happened to capacity, not just activity.**

OSF therefore contributes primarily to the reduction of unnecessary recurring demand and recovery of usable capacity.

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36. EXECUTION EXCELLENCE

The **Execution Excellence System (EES)** converts enabled capability into reliable execution and adaptation.

Its canonical operating loop is:

FIND → FIX → CONTROL → ADAPT → GROW

FIND

Identify the execution constraint or performance condition.

FIX

Address the highest-impact limiting condition.

CONTROL

Stabilize and maintain the improvement.

ADAPT

Respond to changing conditions and learning.

GROW

Extend, improve, and compound organizational execution capability.

Other representations may expand this logic into more detailed implementation flows.

They are not competing canonical cycles.

EES is concerned with reliable execution after relevant conditions, capability, connection, and enablement have been addressed.

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37. TECHNOLOGY AND AI

HEE treats technology and AI as means that can alter organizational capacity, demand, capability, connection, decision-making, and execution.

Technology can:

- reduce demand;
- automate work;
- increase capability;
- improve connection;
- accelerate decisions;
- create new demand;
- increase complexity;
- amplify operational noise;
- or accelerate inefficient processes.

The central HEE question is therefore:

> **Does technology increase Sustainable Execution Capacity — or simply increase the speed of complexity?**

Automation should not automatically be treated as improvement.

If an unnecessary process is automated, the organization may simply make unnecessary demand faster.

HEE therefore supports:

> **Simplify before automating.**

38. EMPLOYEE EXPERIENCE AND CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

Employee Experience (EX) and Customer Experience (CX) are important signals of organizational conditions.

HEE does not treat either as a single deterministic explanation of organizational performance.

Employee Experience

EX may reflect:

- Human Energy conditions;
- demand;
- organizational design;
- enablement;
- decision friction;
- capability connection;
- leadership;
- and other system conditions.

Customer Experience

CX may reflect:

- execution quality;
- operational friction;
- service reliability;
- process design;
- capability;
- capacity;
- and other organizational conditions.

HEE therefore uses EX and CX as important evidence within a wider system.

---

39. SUSTAINABLE EXECUTION CAPACITY

HEE defines **Sustainable Execution Capacity** as:

> **The organization's ability to execute priorities consistently over time without unnecessarily degrading the Human Energy, capability, and Organizational Capacity required for future execution.**

Sustainable Execution Capacity is not merely current capacity.

It concerns the relationship between:

- present execution;
- capacity consumption;
- learning;
- adaptation;
- and future ability to execute.

An organization can achieve strong short-term results while weakening Sustainable Execution Capacity.

HEE considers that an economically important failure.

---

40. SUSTAINABLE BUSINESS VALUE

Sustainable Business Value is value created and maintained without unnecessarily destroying the capacity required to create future value.

HEE therefore distinguishes:

Current Value

from

Value with Capacity Preservation and Renewal

The objective is not to maximize output at any cost.

It is to create valuable outcomes while preserving, developing, connecting, enabling, and renewing the capacity required for continued value creation.

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41. THE HEE CAPACITY MODEL

The HEE capacity model can be represented conceptually as:

Organizational Capacity + Human Energy

↓

Usable Capacity

↓

Capability + Connection + Decision Quality + Enablement

↓

Effective Application

↓

Execution

↓

Sustained Execution

↓

Sustainable Execution Capacity

↓

Sustainable Business Value

This is a conceptual architecture, not an arithmetic model.

The terms should not be interpreted as commensurate numerical variables simply because they are shown in sequence.

The model describes relationships among constructs.

---

42. CONCEPTUAL CAPACITY FORMULATIONS

HEE may eventually require operational formulations for constructs that are currently conceptual.

The following are therefore proposed as conceptual placeholders or future operationalization hypotheses.

Human Energy

Human Energy = f(Potential Capacity, Intensity Alignment, Duration Sustainability)

This suggests that available Human Energy may depend on the relationship among underlying potential, the intensity required, and whether that intensity can be sustained.

Human Energy Leakage

Human Energy Leakage = f(Demand Leakage, Attention Leakage, Capability Leakage)

This identifies three conceptual sources of unnecessary Human Energy loss.

Remaining Human Energy

Remaining Human Energy = Available Human Energy − Measured Human Energy Loss

These formulations are not validated equations.

HEE does not currently claim:

- empirically established functional forms;
- universally measurable units;
- commensurability across all terms;
- predictive validity;
- or mathematical proof of the relationships.

Future research must determine whether and how these constructs can be operationalized quantitatively.

---

43. MEASUREMENT

HEE encourages measurement of what happens to capacity, not merely what happens to activity.

Potential measurement domains include:

- Human Energy;
- demand;
- operational noise;
- capability;
- capability connection;
- Decision Quality;
- enablement;
- execution;
- Sustainable Execution Capacity;
- and value.

Possible measures may examine:

- volume;
- frequency;
- time;
- interruption;

- rework;
- capacity availability;
- utilization;
- recovery;
- application;
- execution reliability;
- and capacity preservation.

The central measurement principle is:

> **Measure what happened to capacity, not only what happened to activity.**

Measurement systems should avoid creating additional unnecessary demand.

---

44. CONSTRUCT DISTINCTION ARCHITECTURE

HEE distinguishes several related but non-identical constructs.

Construct	Meaning
Organizational Drain	Economic condition
Operational Noise	Operational manifestation/mechanism
Human Energy Leakage	Human-capacity manifestation
Capacity Loss	Reduction in available or usable capacity
Capacity Impairment	Capacity exists but is degraded or less usable
Capacity Allocation	How scarce capacity is distributed
Capacity Configuration	How structures, systems, relationships, and resources are arranged
Capability Connection Gap	Existing capability is not connected to the point of need
Enablement Gap	Existing capability cannot be applied because conditions constrain it
Execution Deficit	Intended execution is not achieved
Conversion Failure	Relevant potential appears sufficient, yet valuable application or execution fails

A possible conceptual hierarchy is:

Operational Noise / Human Energy Leakage

↓

may contribute to

Organizational Drain

↓

may produce

Capacity Loss / Capacity Impairment

↓

may contribute to

Application Constraint / Execution Deficit

↓

may affect

Sustainable Execution Capacity

↓

may affect

Sustainable Business Value

This hierarchy is conceptual and diagnostic.

It is not a universal causal law.

---

45. PRIORITIZATION

HEE uses the following conceptual prioritization heuristic:

Priority = Urgency × Dependency × Value Impact

The heuristic directs attention toward issues that are:

- urgent;
- highly dependent upon by other activities;
- and significant in value impact.

It is shared ecosystem infrastructure.

It is not owned exclusively by:

- HEE;
- HEMS;
- EES;
- HEEn;
- 3C;
- OSF;
- or any other individual framework.

The expression is a prioritization heuristic, not validated mathematics.

Its purpose is to support practical decision-making when multiple constraints compete for limited organizational capacity.

---

46. THE HEE IMPLEMENTATION PATH

A practical HEE implementation can follow:

FRAME → AUDIT → DIAGNOSE → IDENTIFY LIMITING CONDITION → PRIORITIZE → RECOVER / DEVELOP / CONNECT / ENABLE / INVESTIGATE → APPLY → EXECUTE → LEARN → ADAPT → RENEW

FRAME

Clarify the strategic objective, scope, and relevant execution context.

AUDIT

Establish visibility into demand, Human Energy, capability, connection, Decision Quality, enablement, and capacity.

DIAGNOSE

Identify the actual limiting condition.

IDENTIFY LIMITING CONDITION

Determine whether the dominant issue is depletion, deficiency, disconnection, constraint, conversion failure, or another condition requiring investigation.

PRIORITIZE

Select the highest-impact condition for action.

INTERVENE

Recover, develop, connect, enable, or investigate as appropriate.

APPLY

Ensure relevant potential can be converted into useful application.

EXECUTE

Produce intended action and outcomes.

LEARN

Capture evidence from execution.

ADAPT

Modify the system based on evidence and changing conditions.

RENEW

Protect and rebuild future capacity.

---

47. HEE MATURITY PATH

HEE maturity can be viewed developmentally as:

Awareness → Measurement → Recovery → Development → Connection and Enablement → Sustainable Execution

Awareness

Recognizing capacity consumption and execution constraints.

Measurement

Creating visibility into demand, Human Energy, capability, connection, enablement, decisions, and execution.

Recovery

Removing or correcting unnecessary depletion.

Development

Building missing capability.

Connection and Enablement

Ensuring capability can reach and operate at the point of need.

Sustainable Execution

Embedding learning, adaptation, protection, and renewal into ongoing execution.

This is a developmental model rather than a rigid organizational maturity scale.

---

48. HEE QUESTIONS THAT LEAD TO ACTION

HEE turns abstract performance problems into actionable questions.

Demand

> What demand is consuming capacity, and which demand creates sufficient value?

Human Energy

> Where is Human Energy being unnecessarily consumed?

Capability

> What capability is missing?

Connection

> What capability exists but is not connected?

Enablement

> What organizational condition prevents capability from being applied?

Decision Quality

> Is scarce capacity being directed through sufficiently sound decisions?

Capacity

> What capacity is being depleted without sufficient value?

Operational Noise

What recurring activity creates insufficient value relative to the capacity it consumes?

Context

Where does the problem originate?

What depends on the activity, capability, decision, or resource?

What constrains action?

Execution

What is preventing application from becoming reliable execution?

Renewal

What capacity did this execution cycle leave behind?

---

49. HEE SIGNATURE QUESTIONS

HEE's signature questions include:

What limits application?

Where is Human Energy being unnecessarily consumed?

What capacity is being depleted without sufficient value?

What capability exists but is not connected?

What organizational condition prevents capability from being applied?

Where does the problem originate?

What depends on the activity, capability, decision, or resource?

What constrains action?

What did this execution cycle consume?

What did it create?

What capacity did it leave behind?

Strategic Test

Can the organization consistently deliver the experience and outcomes it needs to deliver — without consuming the capacity required to do it again?

---

50. THE HEE DIAGNOSTIC CARD

A compact HEE diagnostic can be structured as follows:

Step	Diagnostic
Objective	What are we trying to achieve?
Demand	What is consuming capacity?
Human Energy	What Human Energy is required and being consumed?
Capability	What capability exists?
Connection	Is capability connected to the point of need?
Enablement	Do organizational conditions permit application?
Decision Quality	Is scarce capacity being directed effectively?
Limiting Condition	Depletion · Deficiency · Disconnection · Constraint · Conversion Failure
Response	Recover · Develop · Connect · Enable · Investigate
Capacity Outcome	What happened to usable and future capacity?

The diagnostic card is intended to prevent organizations from jumping directly to solutions before identifying the condition.

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51. HEE AND OTHER MANAGEMENT DOMAINS

HEE is complementary to established management disciplines.

Strategy

HEE examines whether strategic priorities can be converted into sustainable organizational execution.

Operations

HEE examines the capacity implications of operational design, demand, noise, process friction, and execution.

Human Resources

HEE adds an economic-capacity perspective to the management of people and Human Energy.

Organizational Development

HEE complements organizational-development work by examining application, enablement, connection, and sustainable execution.

Process Improvement

HEE examines not only process efficiency but also what capacity the process consumes and what it leaves behind.

Technology Management

HEE examines whether technology increases usable and Sustainable Execution Capacity.

Change Management

HEE considers the Human Energy, capability, connection, decision, enablement, and capacity implications of change.

Performance Management

HEE adds the question of what performance consumes and whether it preserves future execution capacity.

HEE therefore does not seek to replace these disciplines.

It provides an economic lens through which their effects on organizational capacity and sustainable execution can be examined.

---

52. WHAT HEE IS NOT

HEE is not:

- a burnout theory;
- a productivity hack;
- a time-management system;
- an employee-engagement model;

- a capability-development framework alone;
- a process-improvement method alone;
- a technology framework;
- a substitute for strategy;
- a claim that Human Energy explains all organizational performance;
- a claim that every performance problem is caused by organizational drain;
- or a validated predictive mathematical model.

HEE is a conceptual management theory and economic lens focused on organizational capacity and sustainable execution.

---

53. WHAT MAKES HEE AN ECONOMIC LENS

HEE uses economic concepts to examine organizational execution.

These include:

- scarcity;
- allocation;
- consumption;
- depletion;
- recovery;
- development;
- conversion;
- utilization;
- capacity;
- productivity;
- value;
- reinvestment;
- and renewal.

The central economic problem is:

> **How should scarce organizational capacity and Human Energy be preserved, allocated, consumed, developed, and renewed to support valuable execution over time?**

HEE therefore extends performance thinking beyond immediate output toward the economics of repeated execution.

---

54. THE HEE VALUE CYCLE

HEE represents sustainable organizational value creation as a cycle:

CAPACITY

↓

APPLICATION

↓

EXECUTION

↓

VALUE CREATION

↓

LEARNING

↓

ADAPTATION

↓

REINVESTMENT

↓

RENEWED CAPACITY

↓

CAPACITY

The cycle is important because value creation can either:

- strengthen future capacity;
- leave capacity largely intact;
- or consume capacity faster than it is renewed.

HEE focuses on making that relationship visible.

---

55. THE HEE ARCHITECTURE

HEE can be represented through four functional levels.

Level 1 — HEE Theory

Human Energy Economics

The foundational theory and economic lens.

Level 2 — HEMS

Human Energy Management System

The operating-system layer translating HEE into coordinated organizational management.

Level 3 — Complementary Frameworks and Lenses

- HEA — Human Energy Audit
- HERF — Human Energy Recovery Framework
- HEDP — Human Energy Development Plan
- Capability Interconnection
- HEEn — Human Energy Enablement
- 3C — Strategic Context Lens
- EES — Execution Excellence System

Level 4 — Supporting Implementation Mechanisms

- OSF — Operational Silence Framework
- 5R — REMOVE → REDUCE → REPLACE → RE-ENGINEER → RETAIN

Architecture Reconciliation

The level distinction describes **functional role**, not relative importance or a mandatory sequence.

The ecosystem hub presents these elements as complementary components that may operate independently or in combination.

The architecture therefore should not be interpreted as a rigid hierarchy of derivation.

---

56. HEE ECOSYSTEM RELATIONSHIP

The HEE ecosystem is best represented as a **hub-and-spoke system**, not as a tree.

Center

HEE — Human Energy Economics

↓

HEMS — Human Energy Management System

↓

Seven independent complementary spokes:

- **HEA**
- **HERF**
- **HEDP**
- **Capability Interconnection**
- **HEEn**
- **3C**
- **EES**

Alongside these:

OSF + 5R

as a **supporting demand-reduction pathway**.

The outcome logic is:

Effective Application → Execution → Sustainable Execution Capacity → Sustainable Business Value → Renew / Reinvest

Ecosystem Boundary

The diagram does **not** imply that:

- HERF derives from OSF;
- HEDP derives from OSF;
- HEA derives from Capability Interconnection;
- Capability Interconnection derives from 3C;
- or any other specific framework must produce another framework.

The ecosystem represents complementarity and relationship.

It does not imply a mandatory sequence or derivation among the frameworks.

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57. THE HEE CENTRAL PROPOSITION

> **Sustainable organizational performance depends not only on what capacity and capability an organization possesses, but on how effectively it can mobilize, connect, enable, apply, execute, and renew those assets across successive execution cycles.**

This leads to a management imperative:

> **Manage not only for output, but for preservation and expansion of the capacity required to produce valuable output repeatedly.**

The economic objective is therefore not simply:

More output today.

It is:

More valuable application today + stronger capacity for tomorrow.

---

58. THE HEE TEST

HEE proposes a simple strategic test:

> **Can the organization consistently deliver what it needs to deliver without consuming the capacity required to do it again?**

A second formulation asks:

> **Does execution extract from organizational capacity, or does it also protect, develop, connect, enable, and renew that capacity?**

The test does not imply that every execution cycle must increase capacity.

Some legitimate work necessarily consumes capacity.

The issue is whether consumption is justified by value, necessity, protection, development, or future benefit — and whether avoidable degradation is being prevented.

---

59. THE HEE THESIS

Organizations may possess substantial resources and capability yet fail to sustain execution.

This can occur when:

- Human Energy is depleted;
- unnecessary demand consumes capacity;
- capability is disconnected;
- organizational conditions prevent application;
- Decision Quality misallocates scarce capacity;
- operational noise creates friction;
- capacity is lost or impaired;
- or current execution consumes the capacity required for future execution.

HEE's central theoretical contribution is therefore a focus on the **conversion, preservation, and renewal problem**:

> **How does an organization convert potential into valuable application and sustained execution while preserving the capacity required for future cycles?**

The theory shifts attention from capability possession alone toward capability application, execution, and renewal.

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60. FUTURE RESEARCH, SCOPE, LIMITATIONS, AND CONCLUSION

Future Research

Future HEE research should examine the operationalization and empirical validation of:

- Human Energy;
- Organizational Capacity;
- capability;
- capacity;
- application;
- execution;
- sustained execution;
- Capability Connection Gap;
- Enablement Gap;
- Operational Noise;
- Human Energy Leakage;
- Sustainable Execution Capacity;
- diagnostic conditions;
- intervention effectiveness;
- technology and AI effects;
- capacity preservation;
- capacity renewal;

• and sustainable business value.

Research should also investigate HEE across:

• industries;
• organizational sizes;
• cultures;
• organizational structures;
• geographic contexts;
• and different forms of knowledge-intensive and operational work.

Scope

HEE focuses on:

> **Organizational capacity and sustainable execution.**

It is not intended to provide a complete theory of organizational performance.

Many other factors can influence organizational outcomes, including:

• markets;
• strategy;
• competition;
• regulation;
• macroeconomic conditions;
• leadership;
• technology;
• customer behavior;
• capital;
• and external shocks.

HEE addresses one particular problem:

> **How organizations preserve, develop, connect, enable, mobilize, and apply capacity to sustain valuable execution.**

Limitations

HEE is currently a conceptual and evolving management theory.

Its constructs and relationships require further:

• conceptual refinement;
• measurement development;
• empirical testing;
• cross-context validation;

• and possible mathematical operationalization.

HEE does not currently claim:

• validated predictive equations;
• universally applicable causal relationships;
• commensurate units for all constructs;
• or empirical proof of the complete HEE architecture.

Its causal pathways should therefore be treated as conceptual hypotheses and diagnostic propositions until tested.

Conclusion

Organizations can fail not only because capability is absent.

They can fail because:

• capability cannot be applied;
• Human Energy is depleted;
• unnecessary demand consumes capacity;
• capability is disconnected;
• organizational conditions constrain application;
• decisions misallocate scarce capacity;
• operational noise consumes attention;
• or today's results consume tomorrow's capacity.

HEE therefore asks organizations to examine the economics of repeated execution.

The central concern is not simply whether the organization can produce a result.

It is whether it can produce valuable results **again, and again, and again** without unnecessarily degrading the capacity required to do so.

The HEE logic is:

Protect → Diagnose → Recover / Develop / Connect / Enable / Investigate → Apply → Execute → Learn → Adapt → Renew

And the broader value logic is:

Capacity → Application → Execution → Value Creation → Learning → Adaptation → Reinvestment → Renewed Capacity

HEE ultimately proposes a different way of thinking about organizational performance:

More valuable application.
Better execution today.
Stronger capacity tomorrow.

Extraction depletes. Cultivation compounds.

CREATOR AND ORIGIN

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Human Energy Economics emerged from an inquiry into a recurring organizational problem:

> **Why can organizations possess capable people, resources, systems, and knowledge yet still struggle to execute consistently and sustainably?**

The development of HEE has focused on examining the economic relationship among:

- Human Energy;
- organizational capacity;
- capability;
- demand;
- connection;
- decision quality;
- enablement;
- application;
- execution;
- and renewal.

The theory is intended as an evolving contribution to management thinking concerning organizational capacity and sustainable execution.

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Human Energy Economics is informed by established research and management thinking concerning resources, work demands, organizational performance, capability, opportunity to perform, execution, and organizational development.

HEE does not claim ownership of these underlying bodies of knowledge.

Its intended contribution is the integration of these perspectives around a specific management question:

> **How can organizations convert potential into valuable application and sustained execution while protecting and renewing the capacity required for future execution?**

Human Energy Economics — HEE

> **Extraction depletes. Cultivation compounds.**